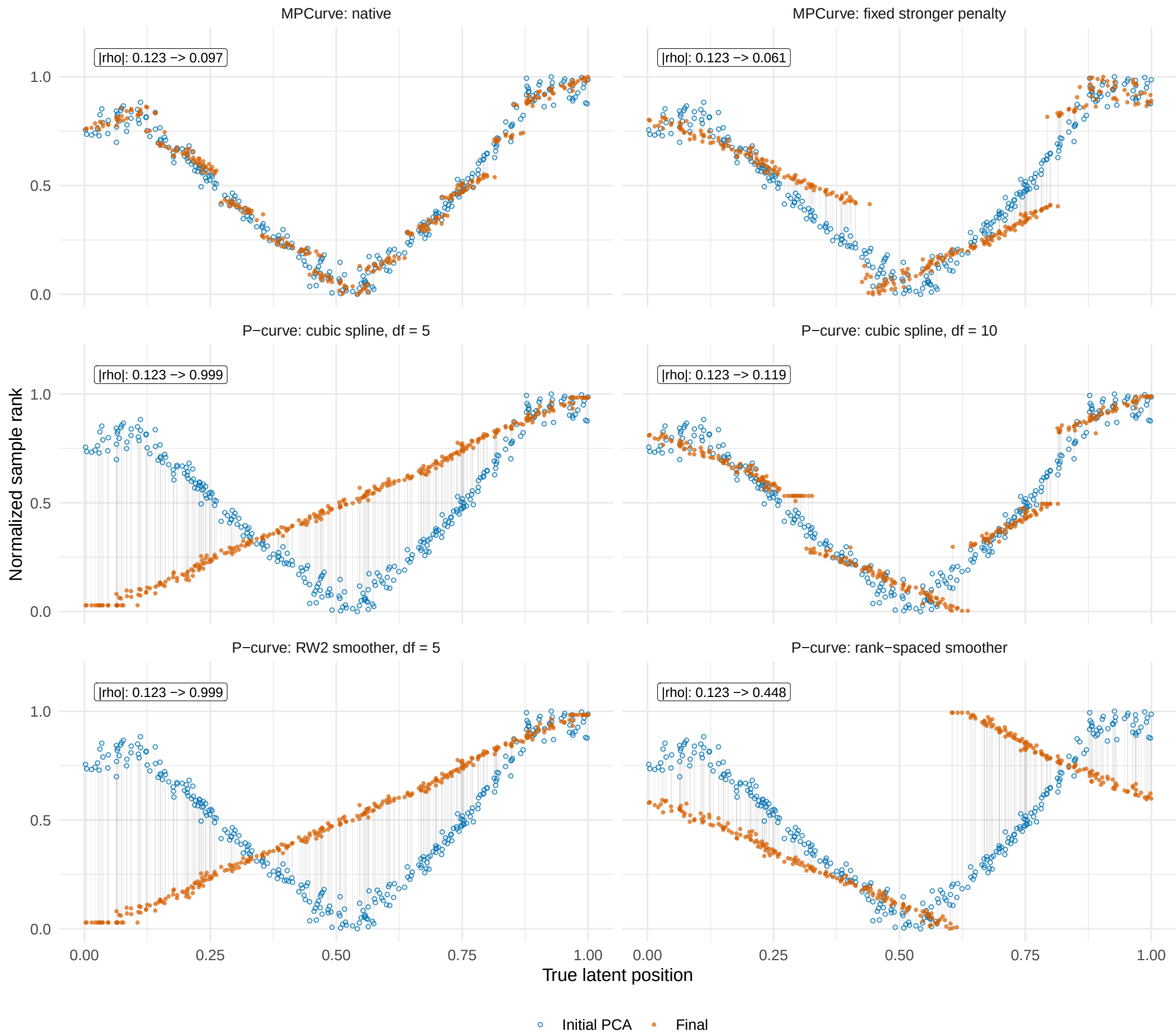


Half-noise B: the penalty family does not determine recovery

Controlled diagnostic variants from the same PCA ordering; all six displayed runs converged.



The RW2 hybrid retains P-curve smoothing/projection/arc-length updates, using 50 regular RW2 basis nodes and $df = 5$. Rank-spacing changes only the smoother input coordinates to ranks; the projection step is unchanged. MPCurve fixed penalty: $\lambda = 10000$, final conditional smoother $df = 5.05-5.91$. Blue/orange show initial/final ranks. These are mechanism diagnostics on one fixed dataset, not new default methods or truth-selected benchmark settings.